Hank's Odyssey: Final-Year Project Gantt Plan

Deadline (For Now): 15th March 2027, although TBD. Dates are a working plan and can be updated as the project progresses.

Plan follows the current Hank's Odyssey / Unity direction. Core first; extra features only if time allows for me. I will try have everything complete by March 15th.

Task	Start Date	End Date	Notes / Deliverable	Status
Confirm scope and success criteria	September 21st 2026	September 25th 2026	Keep the core realistic: 3D platforming, movement and jumping, interaction, a simple combat encounter and a clear ending. Treat character switching and level replay as optional. Project offically begins. A proof of concept is made	Done
Finish proposal and PoC updates	September 28th 2026	October 4th 2026	Use the proposal and Proof of Concept to confirm the project aim, risks, feasibility, core features and what will count as a finished game.	Done
Research games and technical references	September 21st 2026	September 28th 2026	Collect references for 3D platformers (Mario, Sonic, Mega Man), storytelling, cutscenes (Sonic And The Secret Rings), Unity development. Keep notes on what can realistically be used and.	Done
Plan the story and level progression	October 5th 2026	October 19th 2026	Plan Hank's choice at the start, the journey away from Stackland, what will the cutscene for choosing to stay look like. How the stages become more civilised, plan an ending. Keep a realistic scope for the project, accept some features won't be added.	In progress
Stabilise player movement and jumping	October 5th 2026	October 8th 2026	Finish and test movement, camera, jumping, collisions and returning to the spawn point in the Unity prototype. Add an enemy who can be killed too.	Done
Finish and refine the basic gameplay loop	October 12th 2026	October 15th 2026	Make the player able to start, move through the level, interact with an enemy or obstacle, and reach a functional state.	In progress
Create one complete playable level	October 19th 2026	November 19th 2026	Make one complete level, assets can be placeholders or basic and focus on size and scope and how it will feel to complete one stage.	Not Started
Create and refine 3D assets	October 23rd 2026	January 31st 2027	Model the player, enemies, props and environment pieces in Blender and Maya. Prioritise assets that are needed for gameplay and reuse where possible, or use reskins. Seek advice from secondary supervisor Anita for this.	Not started
Build and dress the game environments	November 2nd 2026	January 31st 2027	Develop the planned stages, starting with the most important playable areas. Focus on the ruined Stackland, Swamps and Crystal Caves as they are the most important areas in the game.	Not started
Add the main menu and opening choice	February 8th 2027	February 22nd 2026	Create the start flow and the choice to stay or leave. If the stay option is too much to implement, use a short simple ending/cutscene for it. The cutscene will be done in 2D art style.	Not started
Add enemy combat and boss encounter	November 16th 2026	February 1st 2026	Build a basic enemy encounter first. Prototype the boss separately and simplify it if it takes too long. Combat and a boss are in the project documents. Advanced mechanics like enemies with larger health bars can be considered if time allows.	Not started
Create 2D cutscenes and dialogue	December 1st 2026	February 15th 2027	Create the most important story moments with 2D comic book illustrations, including the opening and ending. Keep cutscenes short and focused on Hank's story. Hank is the main character and the game follows his perspective, use Audacity for audio.	Not started
Record and add voice acting / audio	January 1st 2027	January 3rd 2027	Record Audio and Dialouge, will not take espically long and be realistically done over a weekend	Not started
Add UI, feedback and controller support	November 23rd 2026	December 13th 2027	Add the necessary menus, prompts, score or feedback where useful, and test Xbox controller support alongside keyboard controls.	Not started
Optional features if the core is finished	January 25th 2027	March 1st 2027	Only attempt character switching, extra progression or replay options if the main game is already working. Drop these first if time is tight. They are nice additions but not required for the game	Not started
Integrate the game and stop adding major features	February 8th 2027	February 22nd 2027	Bring together the gameplay, assets, environments, story and audio. After this point, focus on finishing and fixing rather than adding large new features.	Not started

Playtesting and bug fixing	November 2nd 2026	March 1st 2027	Play through the game from start to finish, record problems, fix the important ones and check that the ending can be reached. I will be doing this through most of the project, test as I go, maybe allocate an hour a week	Not started
Build/export and test outside Unity	March 4th 2027	March 8th 2027	Create an executable build and test it outside the Unity editor on a clean run. Check that the game launches and can be completed.	Not started
Write report and evaluate the project	November 2nd 2027	March 8th 2027	Document research, design decisions, implementation, testing, what worked, limitations and any features that had to be simplified.	Not started
Final polish and performance checks	March 4th 2027	March 8th 2027	Fix any remaining high priority issues, check performance and make sure the submitted build is the correct version. This is the final stage	Not started
Prepare presentation, demo and submission	March 8th 2027	March 15th 2027	Prepare the presentation and demo, organise the project files and submit everything required by 15 March 2027.	Not started